

Password Policy

Vantage Cloud Labs

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: 12 July 2026

Policy Owner: Aryan Neupane

Review Cycle: Annual

1. Purpose

The purpose of this Password Policy is to establish minimum security requirements for password creation, authentication, and credential management. Strong authentication practices help protect Vantage Cloud Labs' information systems from unauthorized access and reduce the risk of credential compromise.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees
- Contractors and third-party users
- Temporary staff and interns
- Privileged users and administrators
- All systems, applications, cloud services, and devices owned or managed by Vantage Cloud Labs

3. Password Requirements

The following requirements apply to all user accounts:

- Passwords must contain a minimum of **14 characters**.
- Passwords should include a combination of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters whenever supported.
- Passwords must not contain easily guessable information such as names, birthdays, company names, or common dictionary words.

- Passwords must not be shared with any other individual.
- Passwords must not be stored in plain text or written in unsecured locations.

4. Authentication Requirements

- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)** is mandatory for:
 - All remote access
 - Administrative and privileged accounts
 - Access to cloud services and critical business applications
- Standard user accounts protected by MFA are **not required** to undergo mandatory periodic password changes unless there is evidence of compromise, in accordance with **NIST SP 800-63B** guidance.
- Privileged and administrative account passwords must be changed at least **every 90 days** or immediately following suspected compromise.

5. Password Management

- Users must not reuse any of their **previous 10 passwords**.
- Default or vendor-supplied passwords must be changed before any system, application, or device is placed into production.
- Password reset requests must be verified through approved identity verification procedures.
- The use of an approved password manager is strongly recommended for securely storing and generating unique passwords.

6. Enforcement

Compliance with this policy shall be enforced through the organization's **Identity and Access Management (IAM) platform**, including:

- Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory)
- Active Directory
- Single Sign-On (SSO)
- Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Password history and complexity controls
- Account lockout and monitoring mechanisms

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action and/or suspension of system access.

7. Exceptions

Any exception to this policy must be:

- Documented
- Supported by a valid business justification
- Approved through the organization's **Policy Exception Request** process
- Reviewed periodically to determine whether the exception remains necessary

8. Review

This policy shall be reviewed annually or whenever significant changes occur to authentication technologies, regulatory requirements, or organizational security practices.

Version History

Version	Date	Author	Change Summary
1.0	12 July 2026	Aryan Neupane	Initial policy creation